



ALPINE PEOPLE

RUNNING ACROSS SEVEN DIFFERENT COUNTRIES and approximately 750 miles (1,200 km), the Alps divide the northern and southern parts of mainland Europe. This mountain range

EUROPE'S MOUNTAIN PEOPLE



Outnumbered by skiers

What was once the quiet season is now the busiest and most profitable time of year for many Alpine towns and villages. In some towns, during the skiing season, tourists outnumber locals by 40 to one. Hotels, restaurants, cable cars, and ski lifts as well as many new roads have all been built to support the booming tourist industry.

Tourists also visit the Alps during the summer to hike and enjoy the warmer weather.

Cheese is made by mixing fresh milk with rennet, an enzyme found in the stomach lining of calves reared solely on milk.

DELICIOUS CHEESE

The fresh, sweet grass and wild flowers eaten by Alpine cows result in wonderfully tasty milk and cheese. The best cheeses are made by hand and then left to mature for weeks or months in a special cheese cave where they must be turned over and rubbed with salt on alternate days.

POTATO FARMING

Some Alpine regions provide the right conditions for growing potatoes.

Seeds are planted between February and April and the crop is harvested between May and September. Potatoes were brought to Europe by explorers returning from travels in the New World in the late 1500s.

